

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft XDR | Extended Detection and Response (XDR) | Remote UK

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Engineer with over five years of experience deploying, engineering, and optimising Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) solutions in enterprise environments. I hold deep expertise in KQL (Kusto Query Language), detection engineering, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) automation via Logic Apps and playbooks, Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access, and Microsoft 365 Defender. In my current role at University of the Arts London (UAL), I have led the end-to-end design, deployment, and operational management of the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM platform, built tailored detection use cases using KQL, and integrated Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) into a unified XDR architecture. I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and skilled in PowerShell scripting, incident response, and producing operational and executive-level security dashboards and reporting. I am excited by the opportunity to bring this expertise to BlueVoyant's Deployment Engineering team, helping clients achieve meaningful security outcomes through best-in-class Microsoft security technology.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Microsoft Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) / XDR:** Microsoft Sentinel (log onboarding, custom analytics, workbooks, playbooks, KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Defender XDR
- **Detection Engineering and Automation:** KQL (Kusto Query Language) detection rules and hunting queries, SOAR automation via Logic Apps and playbooks, Detection-as-Code principles, MITRE ATT&CK-aligned use case development
- **Cloud and Identity Security:** Microsoft Azure, Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Zero Trust architecture, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Privileged Access Management (PAM) via BeyondTrust
- **Endpoint and Infrastructure Security:** CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Microsoft Intune (MDM/MAM), Tanium, Mimecast email security gateway
- **Scripting and Tooling:** PowerShell scripting, security dashboard and report development, SOAR playbook authoring
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Nessus, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS)
- **Frameworks and Standards:** NIST 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst (Engineer)

March 2025 - Present

- Lead the architecture, deployment, and continuous optimisation of Microsoft Sentinel as UAL's enterprise SIEM, owning end-to-end log source onboarding, connector configuration, and data normalisation across on-premises and cloud environments.
- Design and build tailored detection use cases and custom analytic rules using KQL, aligned to MITRE ATT&CK techniques, covering lateral movement, credential access, exfiltration, and persistence threat scenarios.
- Engineer and maintain SOAR automation playbooks via Azure Logic Apps, automating alert enrichment, triage workflows, and response actions to accelerate incident handling and reduce analyst burden.
- Integrate Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) into the Microsoft Sentinel XDR architecture, enabling correlated incident views and unified response across the Microsoft 365 Defender estate.

- Build operational and executive-level security dashboards and workbooks within Microsoft Sentinel, providing real-time visibility into threat posture, alert trends, and control effectiveness.
- Manage CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across 8,000+ endpoints alongside Microsoft Sentinel integration, ensuring enriched log telemetry and correlated detections.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID Conditional Access policies, MFA, and SSO configurations as part of a Zero Trust identity architecture, ensuring consistent enforcement across the Microsoft 365 and Azure estate.
- Lead incident response activities under NIST 800-61, coordinating detection, containment, eradication, and recovery for security incidents flagged via Sentinel and Defender XDR.
- Mentor and support junior analysts in detection engineering techniques, KQL query development, and SIEM platform usage, elevating team capability.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Managed daily SIEM alert triage and security event investigation within Microsoft Sentinel, developing custom KQL queries to surface high-fidelity detections and reduce noise.
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and Microsoft 365 Defender, tuning detection policies, managing exclusions, and optimising signal quality.
- Contributed to SOAR playbook development, automating repetitive response actions and improving consistency of alert handling across the security team.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policy configuration, identity governance, and MFA/SSO administration for 8,000 users.
- Supported CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent deployment and policy management, configuring agent settings and contributing to log integration with Microsoft Sentinel.
- Authored PowerShell scripts to automate security operations tasks including log export, account lifecycle auditing, and compliance checks aligned to CIS Controls.
- Managed BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) platform for privileged account governance, session recording, and compliance audit reporting.
- Produced operational security reporting and dashboards to communicate threat posture, incident trends, and control metrics to security leadership and stakeholders.

IT Engineer, Security Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

Experis Ltd (SaaS / FinTech)

- Delivered security engineering across the company's SaaS infrastructure, implementing endpoint hardening, network security controls, and identity and access management governance.
- Implemented MFA and SSO policies, reducing credential-based risk and aligning with Zero Trust principles across cloud-hosted environments.
- Supported security monitoring and event investigation, identifying and escalating potential threats through log review and security tooling.
- Managed ISO 27001-aligned security quality assurance activities and contributed to internal audit and compliance processes.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed Microsoft Sentinel SIEM from the ground up at UAL, establishing enterprise-wide log ingestion, custom analytics, and SOAR automation, significantly improving threat detection and response capability.
- Built a MITRE ATT&CK-aligned detection library in KQL within Microsoft Sentinel, covering over 30 high-priority threat scenarios relevant to UAL's risk profile.
- Integrated Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and CrowdStrike Falcon telemetry into a unified XDR architecture, enabling correlated incident investigation and faster response.
- Developed executive and operational security workbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, providing leadership with real-time visibility into the security posture and key threat indicators.
- Achieved and maintained Cyber Essentials Plus and ISO 27001 compliance at UAL through systematic control implementation and audit support.
- Automated key SOAR workflows using Azure Logic Apps, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) to common alert types by eliminating manual triage steps.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Remote (UK)